GRADE 9 SOCIAL STUDIES
CONTINUOUS ASSESSMENT TEST 1

TERM 1 | TIME: 1 HOUR 15 MINUTES | TOTAL: 50 MARKS

Name: ______________________________ Adm. No.: ____________

School: _____________________________ Date: _______________

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer all questions.
- Use examples where appropriate.
- Write clearly and number your answers correctly.
- The marks for each question are shown in brackets.

SECTION A: SHORT-ANSWER QUESTIONS (20 MARKS)

1. Define the term population. (2 marks)

2. State TWO factors that influence the distribution of population in an area. (2 marks)

3. Differentiate between weather and climate. (2 marks)

4. Name TWO ways in which people can conserve the environment. (2 marks)

5. State TWO reasons why people migrate from rural areas to urban centres. (2 marks)

6. Give TWO examples of natural resources found in Kenya. (2 marks)

7. State TWO responsibilities of a responsible citizen in a community. (2 marks)

8. Identify TWO ways in which cultural heritage can be preserved. (2 marks)

9. State TWO effects of poor waste disposal on a community. (2 marks)

10. Give TWO reasons why maps are useful in the study of places. (2 marks)

SECTION B: STRUCTURED QUESTIONS (30 MARKS)

11. Population and settlement (8 marks)

(a) Explain TWO physical factors that influence where people settle. (4 marks)

(b) State TWO challenges associated with rapid urban population growth. (2 marks)

(c) Suggest TWO measures that can improve living conditions in rapidly growing towns. (2 marks)

12. Environment and resources (8 marks)

(a) Explain THREE benefits of conserving forests. (3 marks)

(b) Describe TWO ways communities can manage solid waste responsibly. (4 marks)

(c) State ONE consequence of soil erosion. (1 mark)

13. Citizenship and culture (7 marks)

(a) State THREE qualities of a responsible citizen. (3 marks)

(b) Explain TWO ways cultural practices can strengthen unity in a community. (2 marks)

(c) Give TWO examples of tangible cultural heritage. (2 marks)

14. Map skills and human activities (7 marks)

(a) State THREE elements commonly found on a map. (3 marks)

(b) Explain why a map key is important. (2 marks)

(c) State TWO economic activities commonly practised in Kenya. (2 marks)

MARKING SCHEME – GRADE 9 SOCIAL STUDIES CAT 1

Total: 50 marks

SECTION A: SHORT-ANSWER QUESTIONS (20 MARKS)

1. The number of people living in a particular area at a given time. (2)

2. Any TWO: availability of water; climate; relief/terrain; soil fertility; employment opportunities; transport; security; access to services. (1 each)

3. Weather is the day-to-day condition of the atmosphere at a place; climate is the average weather pattern of a place over a long period. (1 each)

4. Any TWO: planting trees; protecting water catchments; proper waste disposal/recycling; controlling soil erosion; protecting wildlife; using resources sustainably. (1 each)

5. Any TWO: search for jobs; education; better health services; business opportunities; insecurity or environmental pressures in rural areas. (1 each)

6. Any TWO: water; forests; wildlife; minerals; fertile soils; fish; wind or solar energy resources. (1 each)

7. Any TWO: obeying laws; respecting others and their rights; paying lawful taxes; protecting public property; participating in community activities; caring for the environment. (1 each)

8. Any TWO: teaching language and traditions; documenting oral histories; preserving historical sites and artefacts; holding cultural festivals; passing skills to younger generations. (1 each)

9. Any TWO: spread of disease; blocked drains/flooding; air, soil or water pollution; unpleasant odours; harm to animals; visual pollution. (1 each)

10. Any TWO: show location and direction; help estimate distance; show physical and human features; support planning and navigation; present spatial information. (1 each)

SECTION B: STRUCTURED QUESTIONS (30 MARKS)

11. Population and settlement

(a) Any TWO explained, 2 marks each: relief – flat land is easier to build on and cultivate; climate – moderate conditions attract settlement; water – supports domestic use and farming; fertile soils – support agriculture; natural resources – provide livelihoods. (4)

(b) Any TWO: overcrowding; unemployment; pressure on housing/services; traffic congestion; informal settlements; pollution; increased waste. (1 each)

(c) Any TWO: improve affordable housing; expand water and sanitation; improve public transport; create employment; strengthen urban planning; improve waste collection and health services. (1 each)

12. Environment and resources

(a) Any THREE: forests protect water catchments; reduce soil erosion; provide habitats; absorb carbon dioxide; regulate local climate; provide sustainable products and livelihoods. (1 each)

(b) Any TWO explained, 2 marks each: separate waste at source for recycling/composting; use designated collection points and regular collection; compost biodegradable waste; reuse and recycle suitable materials; dispose of hazardous waste safely. (2 each)

(c) Loss of fertile topsoil; reduced crop yields; siltation of rivers/dams; land degradation. (1)

13. Citizenship and culture

(a) Any THREE: honesty; respect; responsibility; tolerance; patriotism; fairness; participation; respect for the rule of law. (1 each)

(b) Any TWO explained: shared celebrations create belonging; traditional music/dance bring people together; language and stories promote understanding; communal practices encourage cooperation. (1 each)

(c) Any TWO: buildings/monuments; tools; pottery; traditional clothing; sculptures; historical artefacts. (1 each)

14. Map skills and human activities

(a) Any THREE: title; scale; key/legend; compass direction; grid/reference lines; border; source/date. (1 each)

(b) It explains the symbols and colours used on a map so that features can be interpreted correctly. (2)

(c) Any TWO: farming; fishing; livestock keeping; mining; manufacturing; tourism; trade; transport; forestry. (1 each)

Teacher's note: This is original teacher-prepared assessment material. Confirm that the assessed content and map skills have been taught before administering. Accept other relevant and accurate responses.